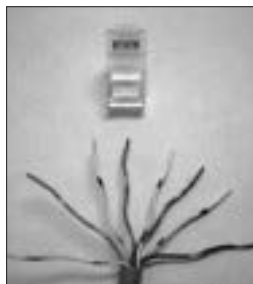


use CAT5 cables. The term category 5 is used to indicate that this is the 5th generation in cabling standards for twisted pair cables. Each category of cabling standards describes the performance characteristics of the wiring standards. Category 5 is one of the best cabling standards available today. It essentially depends on the number of twists per inch and the higher this number the better the performance of the wiring as it will reject noise and provide greater bandwidth.



A CAT5 cable, exposed

7.1.5 DSL

Digital Subscriber Line—see ADSL

7.1.6 Ethernet

This is a networking standard for Local Area Networks. In fact, this is by far the most popular of all networking standards for LANs. It supports speeds of up to 10 Gigbits per second. However, what is more common these days is 100 Mbps speed networks with selective points operating at 1 Gbps. It used special grades of twisted pair copper wires for data transmission though the earlier versions of Ethernet used co-axial cables. The name Ethernet was coined by Robert Metcalf, one of its developers.

7.1.7 Fibre Optics

Fibre optics is the process of transmitting information in the form of modulated light waves through very thin strands of pure glass bundled together. Because the information carrier is light, the information moves at the speed of light across the fibre-optic cable. One of the main uses of fibre-optics is in the area of long distance communication, as fibre optic cables can carry enormous quantities of data.

7.1.8 SDSL

Symmetric Digital Subscriber Line—see ADSL